

The following public holidays are observed in South Africa in 2026 in accordance with the Public Holidays Act No. 36 of 1994.

South African Public Holidays 2026

Date	Day	Holiday
1 January 2026	Thursday	New Year's Day
21 March 2026	Saturday	Human Rights Day
3 April 2026	Friday	Good Friday
6 April 2026	Monday	Family Day
27 April 2026	Monday	Freedom Day
1 May 2026	Friday	Workers' Day
16 June 2026	Tuesday	Youth Day
9 August 2026	Sunday	National Women's Day
10 August 2026	Monday	National Women's Day (observed)
24 September 2026	Thursday	Heritage Day
16 December 2026	Wednesday	Day of Reconciliation
25 December 2026	Friday	Christmas Day
26 December 2026	Saturday	Day of Goodwill

Rules Regarding Public Holidays

- If a public holiday falls on a Sunday, the following Monday is observed as the public holiday.
- Employees who work on a public holiday are entitled to double pay for hours worked.
- Leave applications on public holidays will not deduct from leave balances.
- The LMS system automatically excludes public holidays from working day calculations.